

AUSTIN PATEREK

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Franchise-minded Creative Producer and brand strategist with 12+ years leading complex, multi-stakeholder creative projects from concept through final audience experience — across streaming television, original IP development, and immersive experiential formats. Proven track record managing cross-functional teams, licensee and partner relationships, and concurrent project portfolios for clients including Warner Bros. Discovery, ESPN, Apple, Major League Baseball, and The Pokémon Company, merging traditional media with live audience experiences and location-based activations.

Deep fluency in the full creative lifecycle — from franchise strategy and brand identity development to content marketing, commercial innovation, and live experience execution. Adept at translating bold brand visions into rigorously managed, on-budget, on-brand initiatives that build long-term audience affinity and franchise equity.

EXPERIENCE

Kinda Sorta Almost

Founder, Producer

2023 - Present

- Founded an independent creative studio developing original nonfiction IP for Major League Baseball, ESPN, and Apple — building franchises that extend across linear, digital, OTT, and FAST streaming platforms.
- Leads all franchise and brand strategy from the ground up: defining brand identities, shaping narrative frameworks, and designing the audience journey from first impression through final experience.
- Develops integrated content and marketing strategies, overseeing creative briefing, agency coordination, asset review, and delivery management to drive strong in-market performance.
- Builds detailed business models for ancillary content, live experiences, and immersive audience activations — identifying pathways for original IP to extend beyond the screen into physical and experiential formats.
- Oversees creative teams and manages legal and business affairs across projects, establishing brand guidelines that empower skilled collaborators to execute with consistency and original voice.
- Collaborates with Oscar-winning producers, award-winning directors, and major buyers in the documentary space; synthesizes relationships and learnings to inform future franchise direction and commercial opportunity.

Picture Editor - Freelance

2019 - 2023

- Edited streaming and linear series for Warner Bros. Discovery, The Pokémon Company, A+E Networks, and others — coordinating across creative, legal, and network compliance to meet delivery and brand standards.
- Operated as post producer on most projects, defining project conventions, managing milestone tracking, and delivering on the creative vision of executive stakeholders across matrixed production environments.
- Recent series: Tournament of Champions (Food Network), Baylen Out Loud (TLC).

Story Producer - Freelance

2016 - 2019

- Developed and produced documentary features and streaming series for major buyers and independent distribution — managing all phases of creative and operational execution simultaneously across multiple active projects in a fast-paced, deadline-driven environment.
- Managed cross-functional project teams across creative, editorial, legal, and production disciplines — tracking milestones, flagging dependencies, and keeping concurrent deliverables on schedule without direct authority over all stakeholders.
- Built and maintained detailed project trackers, workback schedules, and deliverable matrices to ensure visibility and on-time coordination across all active productions and stakeholder groups.
- Synthesized and actioned creative notes from multiple executive stakeholders simultaneously — translating competing priorities into clear editorial direction and delivering finished content on compressed timelines
- Cultivated strategic partner relationships across the documentary and feature film community to drive development, production, and post-production pipelines — building a trusted network that accelerated project execution and informed franchise opportunity identification.

Vernon Films

Head of Development 2016 - 2019

- Conceived and developed an original slate of streaming series for a leading creative agency's new content division, overseeing creative direction, brand alignment, and partner deliveries.
- Wrote and pitched series concepts directly to YouTube Originals and other major platform buyers; built executive-ready presentations translating complex IP concepts into commercially compelling narratives.
- Staffed and managed cross-functional project teams; oversaw budgets, scheduling, and multi-project delivery pipelines for the Google Arts & Culture team.

1stAveMachine

Creative Producer 2015

- Oversaw creative development, ideation, and slate management for an award-winning documentary production company — managing franchise IP from inception through pitch and commission.
- Crafted and presented pitches to major streamers and private equity firms; built disciplined project documentation, milestone tracking, and executive-level communication across all active development projects.
- Cultivated strategic relationships across the documentary and feature film ecosystem to build sustainable development, production, and post-production pipelines.

TV Producer - Freelance 2012 - 2015

- Managed large editorial staffs and episode delivery pipelines for major linear networks, coordinating across executive producers, network clients, and post-production teams.
- Wrote original narration and story; synthesized creative notes and mandates from multiple stakeholders to deliver finished episodes on schedule.
- Participated in brand & identity development and strategy. Maintained creative alignment across content and all marketing executed by studios, networks and outside agencies to ensure consistency and series viewership growth.
- Developed deep network across media and marketing with a focus on strategic thinking and narrative integration of brands.

SKILLS

Franchise Strategy & Management • Brand Identity Development • IP Extension • Audience Journey Design • Commercial Innovation • Cross-functional Coordination • Milestone Tracking • Budget & Schedule Management • Workback Scheduling • Vendor & Licensee Management • Creative Suite • Workfront • Asana • Monday • Microsoft Office • Keynote • Airtable • SmartSheet • Creative Producing • Narrative Development • Agency Coordination • Creative Briefing • Asset Review & Approval Workflow • Adobe Creative Suite • Cross-site Coordination • Executive Presentations • Multi-stakeholder Alignment • Leadership-ready Reporting

EDUCATION

University of South Carolina

BA Cultural Anthropology, Media Arts Minor

Certified in human subject research. Published methods paper in academic journal. Dean's List: 4 years. Phi Beta Kappa. Magna Cum Laude.

University of Manchester

MA Visual Anthropology

Focus in visual culture, human geography, and aesthetics — with particular attention to how physical environments, designed spaces, and brand-inflected experiences shape audience behavior and cultural identity. Dissertation selected for placement in the Royal Anthropological Society Library at the British Museum.

REFERENCES

Kati Fernandez

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